

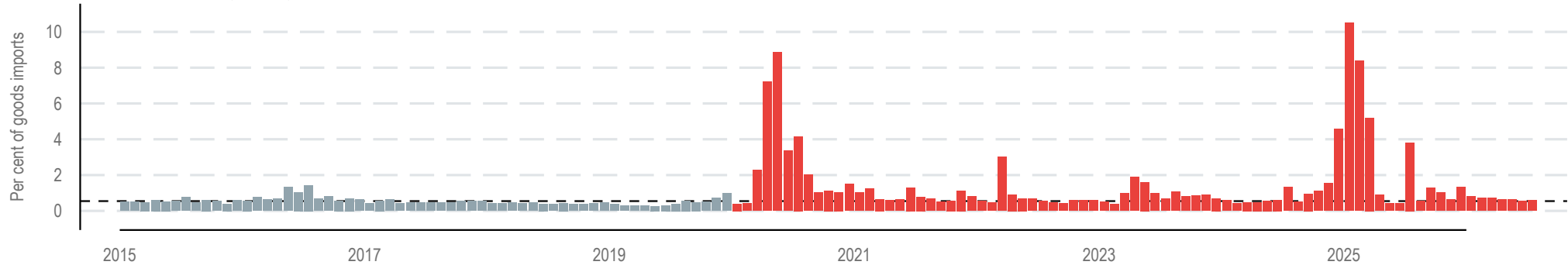
A fixed-weight index cannot see a component whose share moved twentyfold

Gold is in the import price index, but at roughly its base-period weight.

Its actual share of US goods imports reached 10.5% in January 2025. Reweighting it at the share it actually had adds 2.4 points to import price inflation since 2020

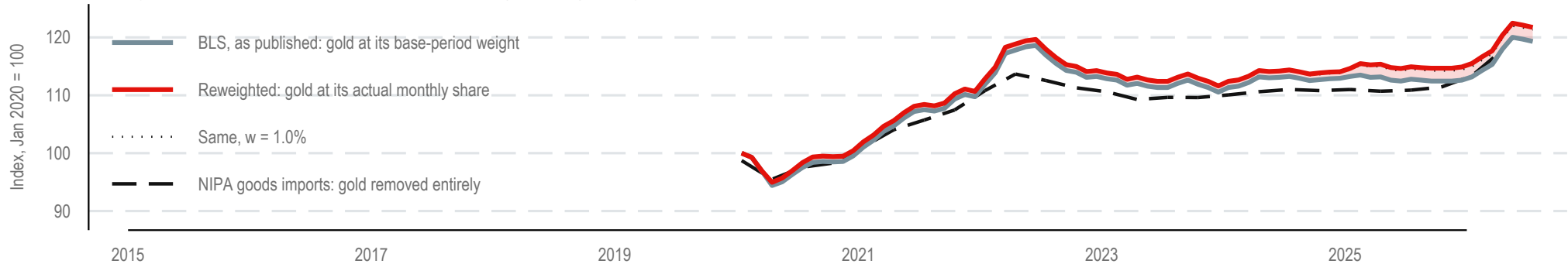
Gold's share of US goods imports

Per cent of the monthly total, by value. The dashed line is the 2015-19 mean, 0.55%



The import price index, as published and reweighted for gold

January 2020 = 100. Three answers to one question: what weight should gold carry in a price index for trade?



The correction is the standard index-number term $(s_t - w_{base}) \times (\text{gold inflation} - \text{non-gold inflation})$, with non-gold inflation backed out of the published index given w_{base} . BLS does not publish the gold weight, so two values bracketing its pre-2020 trade share are shown. This does NOT affect published GDP: BEA removes nonmonetary gold from the national accounts, so they are not deflated through this index. It affects real trade series built from the trade release, and nowcasts bridging from them.

DO NOT READ THE NIPA LINE AS THE GOLD EFFECT. It is quarterly, it excludes gold by construction, and it sits below the published index - but it is also a chain-Fisher index over a different basket, and tested against gold directly the gap does not track it: the correlation between the quarterly NIPA-BLS gap and the predicted gold term is -0.15, and in 2025Q1 the observed gap was seven times the size gold can account for. It is shown because it is what BEA does when it decides gold does not belong in a trade aggregate, not as a measurement of this bias